

Drawing Tools

Learning Objectives

- Use pencil, paintbrush, and airbrush tools
- Adjust brush size, shape, and opacity
- Create freehand drawings and simple illustrations

Engage (5-7 minutes)

A village artist uses different brushes—a thin brush for fine details, a wide brush for filling backgrounds, and a spray can for soft shading. GIMP’s drawing tools work the same way: pencil for sharp lines, paintbrush for smooth strokes, and airbrush for gentle gradients. Today we become digital artists.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Select the Pencil tool and draw a line. Then switch to the Paintbrush and draw the same line—notice the difference in edge softness. Try the Airbrush tool and adjust the rate slider. Change brush sizes using the bracket keys [and]. Draw a simple house with trees using all three tools.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

The Pencil tool draws hard-edged lines with no anti-aliasing, good for pixel art. The Paintbrush draws smooth, anti-aliased strokes that blend naturally. The Airbrush applies color gradually like a real spray, building up intensity over time. All tools allow adjusting size, opacity, and flow to control how much color is applied.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of rangoli making. The pencil is like using a single grain of rice for fine outlines. The paintbrush is like using colored powder for filling shapes. The airbrush is like gently sprinkling powder for a soft, blended effect. Each tool serves a different purpose in creating the full picture. Which tool would you use to draw the outline of a festival banner?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Describe one difference between the pencil and paintbrush tools. Then draw a simple scene using at least two different brushes. If you finish early, experiment with brush dynamics and opacity settings.